

INTEGRATED MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS

ASSIGNMENT PORTFOLIO

A Green Advertising Podcast and an IMC Plan & Pitch for Stanley 1913

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1 Podcast Analysis Preparation

Individual assignment, Part 1 (5%) — selecting an industry podcast on green advertising and preparing questions for a focus-group peer interview.

Industry podcast selected: “The AMP Moment — Green Advertising and Sustainability (Episode 2).”

Consent

Do you consent to your voice being recorded by your peers for the focus group interview, to be used in the production of the podcast for the assessment? — Yes.

Prior Experience

Have you been involved in making a podcast previously? — No.

Most Important Podcast Elements

Based on the chosen industry podcast, the elements considered most important were: sound quality (clarity of voice) and content (interview style, storytelling).

Discussion Questions for the Focus Group Peer Interview

1. What comes to your mind when you think about eco-friendly?
2. What do you understand from green advertising? What are the pros and cons?
3. What can brands do to effectively support their green and sustainability claims?

2 GreenTalk: A Green Advertising Podcast

Individual assignment, Part 2 (20%) — a 5-minute podcast produced from the Part 1 peer interview, the chosen industry podcast, and supporting literature on green advertising and sustainability.

Podcast: GreenTalk — Green Advertising and Sustainability, hosted by Sumeet Telgote with co-host Nadia. Produced for Part 2 of the Podcast Analysis assignment, incorporating the focus-group peer interview and industry podcast from Part 1, along with supporting literature and global/ethical/social considerations. An audio recording of this episode is saved alongside this portfolio as Podcast(1).m4a.

Introduction

Sumeet: “Welcome to the GreenTalk Podcast, where we explore sustainability, eco-friendly innovations, and how brands can make a positive impact on the environment. I'm Sumeet, your host, and I'm excited to have this conversation today.”

Nadia: “And I'm Nadia. We're thrilled to dive into some key topics on how companies and individuals are embracing greener practices.”

Sumeet: “Before we begin, we want to note that the views expressed here are our own, and this podcast is intended to share insights, not offer professional advice.”

Main Discussion

Sumeet: “In today's episode, we'll be discussing eco-friendly practices and the evolving role of sustainability in the world. So let's start with the first question for you, Nadia.”

Question 1: “What comes to your mind when you think about eco-friendly?”

Nadia: “So the first thing that comes to mind is the use of better material alternatives, whether it be paper straws instead of plastic straws, reusable bags instead of plastic bags, or even bamboo cutlery. It's really about reducing our reliance on single-use plastics and finding sustainable substitutes.”

Sumeet: “That's a great perspective. For me, eco-friendliness often means reducing waste, conserving resources, and choosing sustainable options in our daily lives. It's about making thoughtful choices that minimize our environmental footprint.”

Question 2: “Now, let's shift to green advertising. What do you understand from green advertising, and what do you see as the pros and cons?”

Nadia: “I think businesses will use misleading language to appear eco-friendly or even design their packaging in a way that looks eco-friendly. But they're not genuinely following through on sustainable practices — that's greenwashing, and it's one of the biggest risks with green advertising.”

Sumeet: “I completely agree. Green advertising can be a powerful way to connect with consumers who care about the environment, but it does come with risks. When done poorly or dishonestly, it can lead to a loss of consumer trust and damage a brand's reputation long-term.”

Question 3: “Building on that, what do you think brands can do to effectively support their green and sustainability claims?”

Nadia: “I think the higher-ups in businesses should create a proper strategy for their industrial practices — a strategy that can be followed through by their employees — while also emphasizing the importance of transparency in reporting their progress.”

Sumeet: “Exactly. Authenticity and transparency are key. It's not enough to claim you're green — you have to prove it with concrete actions and measurable results. Consumers today want to see real commitments, not just marketing language.”

Canadian Government Tax Incentives Discussion

Sumeet: “One interesting development we're seeing in Canada is the government's push to encourage businesses to adopt more sustainable practices. One of the ways they're doing this is through tax incentives.”

Specifically, through the Accelerated Capital Cost Allowance (ACCA) program, businesses can deduct up to 100% of the costs for clean energy equipment in the first year. This applies to things like renewable energy systems and energy-efficient technology.

Additionally, Canada's Net-Zero Accelerator Fund has allocated over \$8 billion to support businesses in reducing their emissions and transitioning to sustainable operations. This is all part of Canada's broader climate strategy to push companies toward greener practices.

Conclusion

Sumeet: “To wrap up, being eco-friendly is no longer just an option — it's becoming a core expectation for both businesses and consumers. Thanks again, Nadia, for sharing your thoughts. And thank you to our listeners for tuning in.”

Nadia: “Be sure to subscribe to GreenTalk for more conversations on sustainability and the future of eco-friendly practices.”

Sumeet: “Until next time!”

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3 IMC Plan & Pitch: Stanley 1913

Group project (35%) — an integrated marketing communications plan and pitch presentation for Stanley 1913, co-authored with Timur Zonduev, Rachel Nguyen, and Hyeun Park (Group B).

Group B: Timur Zonduev (T00726802), Rachel Nguyen (T00716645), Hyeun Park (T00760771), Sumeet Telgote (T00711269). Submitted November 26, 2024.

Situation Analysis

1. Background Analysis of Stanley 1913

Brand Overview: Stanley 1913, founded by William Stanley Jr., revolutionized drinkware with the invention of the all-steel vacuum bottle in 1913. The brand is known for its durable, high-quality outdoor gear, particularly insulated food and beverage containers. Over the years, Stanley has expanded its product range to include bottles, tumblers, growlers, and more, catering to rugged, active lifestyles.

Market/Industry: Stanley operates in the drinkware industry, which includes a variety of products such as bottles, mugs, and tumblers. The industry is characterized by a growing demand for eco-friendly and sustainable products. Key competitors include Yeti, Hydro Flask, and Thermos.

2. Current Media Trends in the Industry

Competitors: Yeti and Hydro Flask are known for their high-quality, durable drinkware and have a strong market presence, focusing heavily on outdoor and adventure themes. Thermos, another long-standing competitor, offers a wide range of insulated products and has a strong reputation for reliability.

Customers: an increasing preference for eco-friendly and sustainable products; a growing trend of personalization and custom-designed drinkware; and high demand for products that cater to on-the-go lifestyles.

Suppliers and Intermediaries: suppliers are focusing on sustainable materials like stainless steel and BPA-free plastics. Retail intermediaries include both physical stores and online platforms, with a significant shift towards e-commerce.

3. Current Business Goals, Marketing Strategies, and Communication Tactics

Business Goals: increase market share in the drinkware industry; expand the customer base to include a broader demographic, particularly women.

Marketing Strategies: Rebranding — Stanley shifted from a male-dominated outdoor brand to a versatile lifestyle brand appealing to women. Influencer Marketing — collaborations with influencers and social media campaigns have been pivotal in reaching new audiences. Limited Edition Releases — creating a sense of exclusivity with limited edition products.

Communication Strategies and Tactics: Social Media Engagement — active presence on platforms like Instagram and TikTok, leveraging user-generated content and viral marketing. Storytelling — emphasizing the durability and emotional connection of their products through customer stories and brand narratives. Collaborations — partnering with other brands and influencers to reach new audiences.

4. Target Audience Analysis

Audience Personas: Outdoor Enthusiasts — traditionally Stanley's core audience, including campers, hikers, and blue-collar workers. Millennial and Gen Z Women — recently targeted through influencer marketing and social media campaigns. Families and Everyday Users — expanding to include products for daily use, appealing to a broader demographic.

Customer Journeys: Awareness — through social media, influencer endorsements, and viral content. Consideration — engaging content and storytelling that highlights product benefits and emotional connections. Purchase — easy access through e-commerce platforms and physical stores. Post-Purchase — encouraging user-generated content and community engagement to foster brand loyalty.

5. Key Areas for Improvement

Enhanced Personalization — offering more customizable options to cater to individual preferences. Sustainability Initiatives — highlighting eco-friendly practices and products to appeal to environmentally conscious consumers. Expanded Influencer Partnerships — collaborating with a diverse range of influencers to reach different segments of the market. Interactive Content — creating more interactive and engaging content, such as live Q&A sessions, tutorials, and behind-the-scenes looks.

By leveraging these insights and focusing on these key areas, Stanley 1913 can further enhance its integrated marketing communications and continue to grow its market presence.

Strategic Objectives

1. Increase Brand Awareness Through Sustainability Messaging

Objective: increase brand awareness by 20% within the target audience over six months by integrating sustainability initiatives into 50% of all communication channels and campaigns.

Rationale: based on market analysis, sustainability is a top priority for both Stanley and its consumers. Highlighting sustainability through clear messaging aligns with the business goal of promoting social responsibility and brand image, and attracts environmentally conscious customers.

Duration: 6 months (January–June 2025, ~26 weeks). Weeks 1–4: audit current channels, develop sustainability-focused messaging, align content calendars. Weeks 5–12: launch sustainability-themed campaigns, monitor and optimize, track awareness via impressions/clicks/shares. Weeks 13–21: scale up successful strategies, introduce behind-the-scenes storytelling. Weeks 22–26: final analysis comparing baseline to post-campaign awareness.

2. Enhance Customer Engagement Through Personalized and Interactive Content

Objective: achieve a 25% increase in customer engagement across digital platforms within three months by implementing interactive and personalized content such as quizzes, polls, and tailored product recommendations.

Rationale: market analysis indicates customers value brands catering to their specific needs and preferences. Personalization and interactivity create a more engaging experience, building stronger emotional connections and increasing the likelihood of repeat interactions.

Duration: 3 months (February–April 2025, ~13 weeks). Weeks 1–4: analyze customer data, develop quizzes/polls and a recommendation engine, plan launch content. Weeks 5–8: launch personalized campaigns, implement dynamic email content, monitor engagement metrics. Weeks 9–13: iterate based

on responses, add new interactive elements, compare baseline vs. achieved engagement against the 25% target.

3. Lead Generation Campaigns via Expanded Influencer Partnerships and UGC Competitions

Objective: generate 1,000 qualified leads from influencer-driven campaigns within four months by collaborating with 15–20 influencers whose audiences align with the brand's target demographics, running competitions, giveaways, and UGC campaigns.

Rationale: influencer partnerships have proven effective in amplifying reach and driving conversions. Expanding this strategy aligns with the business goal of driving sales while maintaining an honest connection with the audience.

Duration: 4 months (March–June 2025, ~17 weeks). Weeks 1–4: identify and shortlist 15–20 influencers, develop campaign briefs. Weeks 5–8: launch initial campaigns and giveaways, set up lead-tracking (unique links/promo codes). Weeks 9–13: expand campaigns, begin UGC campaigns, track leads toward the 1,000-lead goal. Weeks 14–17: analyze progress, host a final giveaway/competition push, summarize ROI.

Strategies & Tactics

Objective 1: Increase Brand Awareness Through Sustainability Messaging

Strategy: implement a comprehensive sustainability campaign that highlights Stanley's commitment to environmental responsibility across all communication channels.

Tactics and Channels: Content Marketing — blog posts, videos, and infographics on sustainability initiatives (recycled materials, reduced plastic packaging). Social Media Campaigns — behind-the-scenes looks at sustainable practices on Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter. Email Newsletters — regular updates on eco-friendly products and sustainability milestones. Partnerships — collaborating with environmental organizations on co-hosted events or campaigns.

Justification: sustainability messaging aligns with Stanley's brand values and appeals to environmentally conscious consumers, potentially increasing market share; consumers increasingly prioritize sustainability, so showcasing these efforts can enhance brand loyalty and trust.

Media Plan

Platform	Timing	Purpose
Blog	Bi-weekly posts	Educate audience on sustainability efforts
Social Media	Daily updates	Engage and inform followers
Email Newsletters	Monthly	Keep subscribers informed and engaged
Partnerships	Quarterly events	Broaden reach and credibility

Action Plan

Task	Timeframe	Responsibility	Budget Estimate
Develop content calendar	2 weeks	Content Team	\$2,000
Create multimedia content	Ongoing	Marketing Team	\$5,000
Identify and approach partners	1 month	PR Team	\$3,000
Monitor and analyze campaign impact	Ongoing	Analytics Team	\$2,000

Objective 2: Enhance Customer Engagement Through Personalized and Interactive Content

Strategy: launch personalized and interactive digital experiences to deepen customer engagement and foster a sense of community.

Tactics and Channels: Interactive Quizzes — product recommendations based on user preferences. User-Generated Content (UGC) — encouraging customers to share product experiences on social media, with selected posts featured on official channels. Personalized Email Campaigns — tailored recommendations and content based on customer behavior and purchase history. Virtual Events — webinars or live streams demonstrating product uses, care tips, and sustainability discussions.

Justification: personalized and interactive content can increase customer retention and lifetime value by fostering deeper connections, and makes customers feel valued and understood.

Media Plan

Platform	Timing	Purpose
Website	Monthly quizzes	Drive traffic and engagement
Social Media	Weekly UGC features	Drive traffic and engagement
Email	Bi-weekly campaigns	Maintain personalized communication
Virtual Events	Quarterly	Educate and engage customers

Action Plan

Task	Timeframe	Responsibility	Budget Estimate
Develop interactive content	1 month	Digital Team	\$4,000
Set up UGC campaigns	2 weeks	Social Media Team	\$2,000
Segment email lists for personalization	3 weeks	CRM Team	\$3,000
Plan and execute virtual events	2 months	Events Team	\$5,000

Objective 3: Lead Generation Campaigns via Expanded Influencer Partnerships and UGC Competitions

Strategy: collaborate with influencers to create engaging campaigns that include giveaways and user-driven design competitions, showcasing Stanley products while fostering a sense of community and ownership among customers.

Influencer Partnerships: sign contracts with 15–20 influencers from lifestyle, outdoor, and sustainability niches to create a series of posts and videos featuring Stanley products, focused on Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube, with exclusive discount codes or tracking links for each influencer.

Giveaways: a “Picture with Stanley” campaign where participants share creative photos using Stanley products, tagging the brand with a campaign hashtag (#MyStanleyWaterbottle); winners receive gift cards, exclusive products, or a feature on Stanley's official social media.

User-Driven Design Competition: fans submit custom designs for Stanley products (e.g., tumbler or water bottle artwork); the winning design is featured in a limited-edition product line, with credit to the designer.

Lead Magnets and Landing Pages: dedicated landing pages for giveaways and design competitions to collect participant data (e.g., email addresses) for future campaigns.

Evidence-Based Justification: influencers drive 11x higher ROI than traditional marketing (HubSpot); competitions build strong brand loyalty, emotional connection, and repeat purchases.

Justification of Media Choices: Instagram/TikTok — highly visual, high engagement, especially among younger audiences. YouTube — excellent for in-depth product storytelling and long-form content on durability and usability. Email Campaigns — keeps participants engaged with updates and offers. Website Landing Pages — centralizes campaign participation and data collection.

Media Plan

Platform	Timing	Purpose
Instagram/TikTok	Weekly influencer posts	Boost visibility, engagement, and trend potential.
YouTube	Monthly influencer videos	Showcase products in authentic, real-world use.
Email Campaigns	Bi-weekly	Drive participation in giveaways and competitions.
Website Landing Pages	Ongoing	Capture leads and drive competition participation.

Action Plan

Task	Timeframe	Responsibility	Budget Estimate
Identify and contract influencers	1 month	Digital Team	\$30,000

Task	Timeframe	Responsibility	Budget Estimate
Launch "Picture with Stanley" giveaway	6 weeks (prep) + 2 months (live)	Social Media Team	\$10,000
Create competition landing pages	3 weeks	Web Development Team	\$5,000
Host user design competition	3 months	Marketing & Design Teams	\$15,000 (production + prizes)

Expected Outcomes: increased engagement from influencer content and user-generated campaigns; boosted sales from tracked influencer-driven conversions and competition-driven leads; stronger customer loyalty from giving customers a stake in Stanley's product line.

Measurement

Objective 1: Increase Brand Awareness Through Sustainability Messaging

NPS (Net Promoter Score): the extent to which people who engaged with the campaign would recommend the brand. A high NPS indicates increased customer satisfaction and brand loyalty, and quantitatively shows whether sustainability messaging is driving trust and loyalty. Measured via a 0–10 recommendation survey (Promoters 9–10, Passives 7–8, Detractors 0–6), distributed through email surveys to newsletter subscribers, website pop-up surveys after engaging with sustainability content, and post-event feedback for sustainability initiatives.

Volume Data: the total number of interactions, sales, or activities within a period — website visitors, social media reach, content views, and email opens/clicks — used to gauge consumer interest and engagement, and whether the sustainability message changed loyalty and participation. Collected via website traffic, social media engagement (likes/shares/comments), email open rates, and campaign/event participation (registration forms and attendance records).

Objective 2: Enhance Customer Engagement Through Personalized and Interactive Content

CES (Customer Effort Score): measures how easy it is for customers to engage with the brand or complete an action. If the quizzes, UGC campaigns, and personalized experiences are easy to access and use, a higher CES signals a smoother, more enjoyable experience. Collected via post-interaction surveys ("Very Easy" to "Very Difficult") embedded on the website or emailed after interactions.

Engagement Rate (Quizzes/UGC): tracks likes, shares, comments, and participation in quizzes or UGC campaigns to assess "ease of customer experience" and "customer participation." Collected via social media and website analytics tools, email marketing platform metrics (open/click-through rates), and virtual-event platform engagement reports (attendance, chat activity, question submissions).

Objective 3: Lead Generation via Expanded Influencer Partnerships and UGC Competitions

Sales Conversion Rate: the percentage of visitors or participants who complete a purchase after engaging with a campaign ($\text{purchases} \div \text{participants/visitors} \times 100\%$). A crucial metric for assessing how effectively marketing efforts drive revenue and which channels generate the highest ROI.

Influencer Partnerships: tracked via unique discount codes/links per influencer, plus social media engagement (likes, shares, comments).

Giveaway: tracked via the campaign hashtag (#MyStanleyWaterbottle) across social platforms — participant counts, shared posts, and tagged photos.

User-Driven Design Competitions: tracked via submission platforms (web forms) and related social media activity.

Lead Magnets and Landing Pages: tracked via sign-up forms on dedicated landing pages, capturing email addresses and preferences for future campaigns.

Recommendations

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Sustainability Practices

To establish Stanley as a leader in sustainable practices, we recommend hiring a CSR expert. Why it matters: customers are increasingly aligning with brands that reflect their values, particularly in sustainability. Action plan: assess Stanley's current sustainability efforts; identify areas for improvement such as reducing environmental impact in manufacturing and packaging; develop measurable, transparent goals (e.g., lowering carbon emissions, using recycled materials). Outcome: positions Stanley as an authentic, eco-conscious brand, resonating with environmentally-aware consumers and enhancing brand reputation.

Use of Outsourcing Companies

Effective social media management requires specialized skills and expertise, so we recommend outsourcing to a professional marketing agency. Why: in-house teams may lack the time or expertise for advanced campaigns, while agencies bring fresh perspectives, innovative tools, and data-driven strategies. Action plan: partner with a reputable agency aligned with Stanley's brand values, focused on engaging, visually compelling content tailored to Stanley's audience. Outcome: a cohesive, professional approach to marketing that increases engagement, brand reach, and ROI.

Social Media Marketing Plan

A strategic, well-organized social media marketing (SMM) campaign is essential for building awareness and maintaining relevance. Why: planning a campaign 3 months in advance allows for consistency, creativity, and alignment with key events or trends. Action plan: define campaign goals and target audience personas; use a mix of content formats (short videos, tutorials, UGC, contests); incorporate sustainable practices into messaging (e.g., behind-the-scenes of eco-friendly production). Outcome: higher engagement, consistent messaging, and increased customer loyalty.

Listen to Audience

Social media is a two-way communication channel. Why: customers want to feel heard and valued — engaging sincerely builds trust and loyalty. Action plan: assign a dedicated team to monitor comments, direct messages, and mentions across platforms; be transparent in responses, addressing concerns honestly; use audience feedback to refine products and marketing strategies. Example tactic: host regular Q&A sessions or polls to learn what resonates with customers. Outcome: fosters community, boosts brand authenticity, and keeps Stanley attuned to evolving customer preferences.

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